


call it a year. The remaining quarter day is added once in every four years in the month of February. That is why February has 29 days once in four years. It is called a **Leap Year**. The inclination of the Earth on its axis and its revolution around the Sun cause different seasons.

**Activity:**

Circle the leap years: 2000, 2005, 2012, 2014, 2017, and 2020

The Northern Hemisphere is inclined towards the Sun for six months from 21st March to 23rd September while the Southern Hemisphere is tilted away from the Sun.

**HOTS:** Priya is 12 years old. How many times she would have revolved around the Sun?

From Sep 23rd to March 21st the southern hemisphere is inclined towards the Sun and the northern hemisphere faces away from the Sun. The changing position of the Earth in its orbit during revolution gives the impression that the Sun is continuously moving north and south of the equator. The equator faces the Sun directly on 21 March and 23 September. These two days are called **Equinoxes**, during which the day and night are equal throughout the Earth.




**Perihelion** is the Earth's closest position to the Sun. **Aphelion** is the farthest position of the Earth from the Sun.

On 21st June, the Tropic of Cancer faces the Sun. This is known as **Summer Solstice**. It is the longest day in the Northern Hemisphere and longest night (shortest day) in the Southern Hemisphere. On 22nd December, the Tropic of Capricorn faces the Sun. It is called as **Winter Solstice**. It is the longest day in the Southern Hemisphere and longest night (shortest day) in the Northern Hemisphere.